Splitting User Stories

Sequence of techniques…

User goal decomposition

- Split the user goals into sub goals

As an owner of unwanted stuff

I can register for an online auction website

So that I can sell my stuff

As an owner of unwanted stuff

I can enter my registration details (name, email, etc)

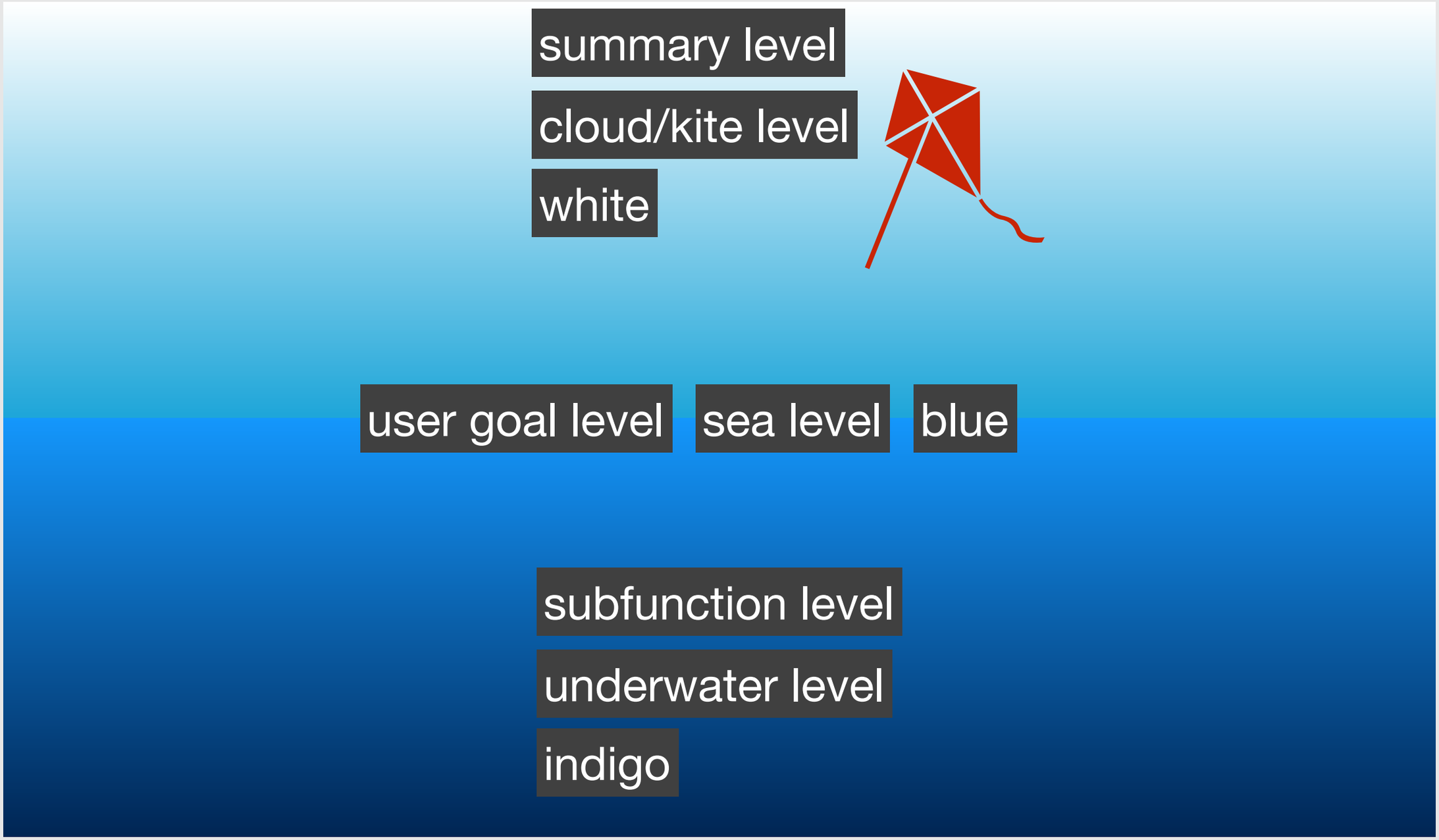
So that I can register for an online auction website

As an owner of unwanted stuff

I can submit my registration details

So that I can register for an online auction website

Three named goal levels



Split out NFRs

- Separate functional and non-functional requirements of a user story
- Defer the following NFRs
- Performance - speed
- Scalability - large data or large set of users
- Concurrency - Race conditions, data locking, concurrent users
- Availability/Reliability - uptime, robustness
- Security - protect from attack
- Usability / accessibility - easy to use for everyone
- UX - making it look nice
- Cross browser / platform - work for a variety of clients
- Internationalisation - language support

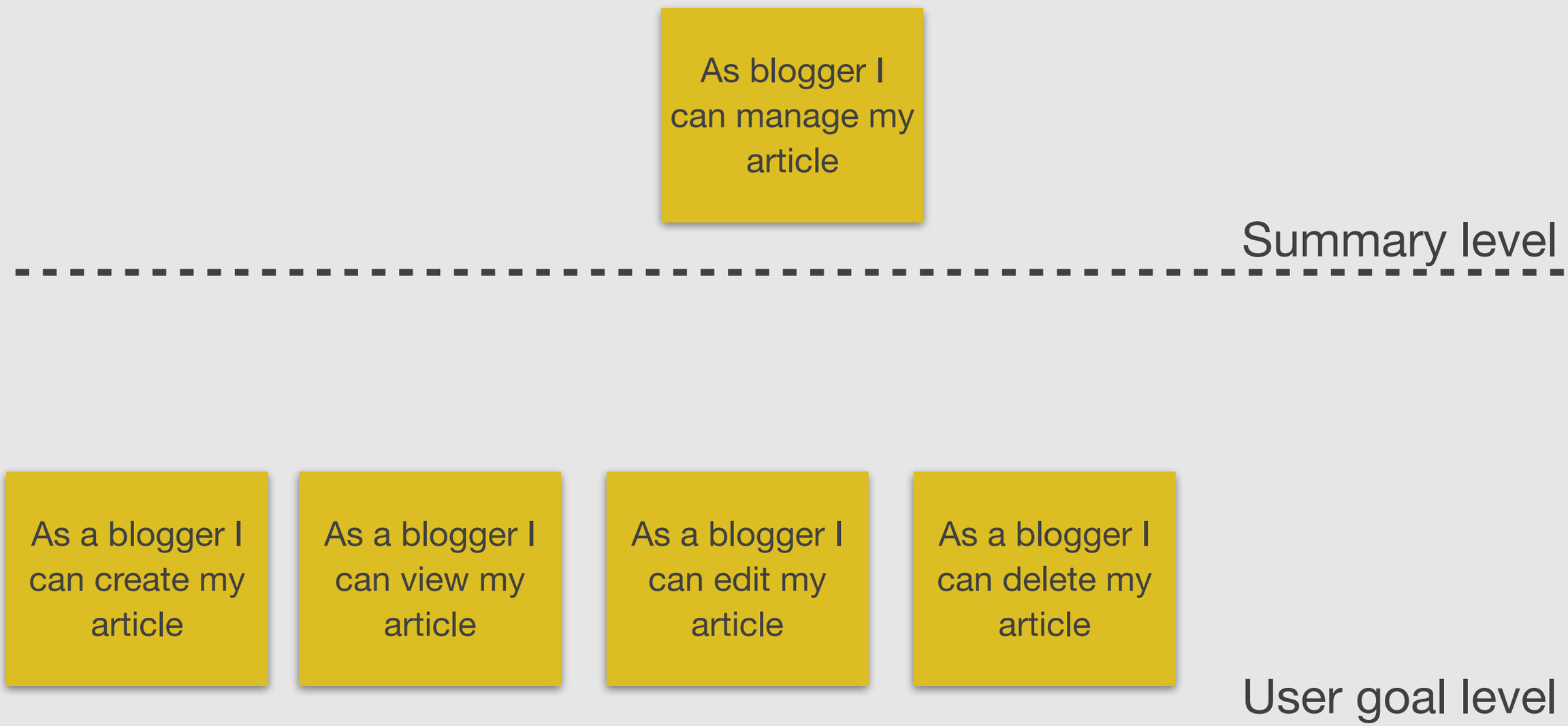
Split by User Interface Channel

- Special case for cross browser / platform support
- Multiple devices
  - Desktop
  - Tablet
  - Mobile
- Platforms
  - Windows
  - Mac
  - iOS
  - Android

Split by User Type

- Some stories have a diverse range of users
- As a user I want to register
  - Teacher
  - Parent
  - Principle

Split summary goals into user goals



Split by Scenario / Flow

- Happy paths versus unhappy paths
- Deliver common happy paths
- Identify alternative flows
- Sign in
  - success
  - Invalid username or password
  - failed 3 times
  - account locked

Split by Scenario / Flow

Write out steps for core happy path (sign in) to find alternative paths

1. User requests sign in
2. System present sign in form
3. User enters username and password
4. System verifies sign in details for an existing account
5. System verifies account is active
6. System verifies account is not locked
7. System logs in and displays dashboard

Bronze plated / Gold plated flow

As blogger I want to register

* Date of Birth is required

Basic but good enough for MVP

Textfield

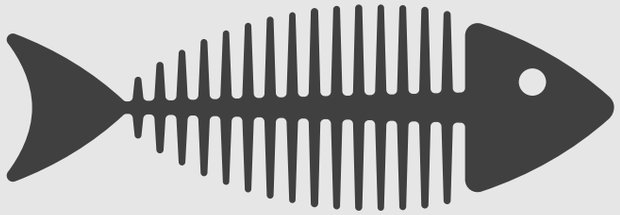
Bells and whistles

Calendar picker

Bronze plating tricks

- **Manual versus automatic** - manual for low infrequent tasks
- **Hard-coded versus configurable**
- **Assumed versus asked** - default versus personalised
- **Simple versus complex** - address look up versus manual entry

Skeleton



- Build end to end and then fill in the gaps
  - Register button > empty form with submit button
  - Completes registration
- Stub out the back end code to focus on UI flow